SHADOW WORK ACADEMY

Inner-Critic Reflection Worksheet

An eight-step guide for separating facts from assumptions and writing a balanced response. Reusable as often as you like.

Worksheet: Inner-Critic Reflection

Use a recent situation where your inner critic was loud. Work through each step in order. Write in full sentences if you can; it slows your thinking down in a useful way.

Completed example (fictional): Priya's Inner-Critic Reflection

1. SITUATION

I sent a draft to my manager. The reply was one word: "Noted."

2. THE CRITIC'S WORDS

"She hated it. She's losing confidence in me. I should have asked for feedback sooner."

3. FACTS

The reply said "Noted." Thursdays are back-to-back meetings for her.

4. ASSUMPTIONS

That she hated it, that she's losing confidence, that I should have asked sooner.

5. OTHER EXPLANATIONS

She's busy. The draft is fine. She plans to review it later.

6. WHAT I'D SAY TO SOMEONE I RESPECT

"One word from a busy person isn't a verdict. Ask for specifics."

7. BALANCED STATEMENT

I don't know what "Noted" means yet. I can ask for specific feedback on Friday.

8. PRACTICAL NEXT STEP

Keep working on what I planned, and send a short feedback request on Friday.

Fictional example for illustration. Your own answers can be shorter, messier, and entirely different.

1. Situation — what happened, in camera-fact terms only:

2. The critic’s words — write exactly what your inner voice said:

3. Facts — which parts of the above could a neutral observer confirm?

4. Assumptions — which parts are interpretation, prediction, or mind-reading?

5. Other explanations — list at least two alternatives that also fit the facts:

6. What would I say to someone I respect in this exact situation?

7. A balanced statement — honest about what went wrong, specific, and not a verdict on my character:

8. One practical next step that follows from the balanced statement:

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